Outlook

Re: Time keeping Close out

From Cathy Choi <Cathy.Choi@mcdgroup.com>
Date Tue 5/19/2026 9:33 AM
To Jonathan Navarrete <Jonathan.Navarrete@mcdgroup.com>

Hi Jonathan,

Thank you for your email.

I acknowledge that some MyHours entries could have been recorded more clearly and more promptly.

However, I do not accept the way this matter has been framed as a trust issue caused solely by me.

My role was to support project delivery and provide digital engineering outcomes requested by the project. The feedback I received from the project team was positive regarding the quality and usefulness of my work. The core issue here appears to involve project budget control, task approval, and expectation management, rather than simply my individual time recording.

For Nafanua, digital engineering tasks were requested and completed to support the project. If the project had a limited budget, then the appropriate control should have been to confirm the scope, expected hours, and project manager approval before the work started. This should not now be raised **afterwards** as an individual conduct issue when the work was already delivered and accepted.

I also want to clarify the timeline, I raised this transparently when asked.

1. On 03 March 2026, it appears that James reviewed the cost and questioned the level of digital engineering hours charged to the project. My understanding is that this was a project cost concern, twice the cost they thought.

2. On 10 April 2026, led to further discussion, emails, and alignment around project work hours and expectations. and ensure James was involved before any further Nafanua-related work proceeded, so that scope and expectations were aligned.

3. On 14 May 2026, related to the April time query. I have already clarified that part of the 23 April time entry was not accurately attributable to the Nafanua task itself due to laptop and Autodesk system issues affecting my ability to work properly. My laptop was reset by Stephen on 23 April between approximately 1:00 pm and 2:30 pm, and I confirmed that the actual time spent on the Nafanua request that day was approximately 2 hours. James appeared to understand this clarification.

I am concerned that a wider project budget and scope-control issue is now being reframed as an individual trust or conduct issue without considering the full project context, I understand you have been challenged by James on costs a few times. At the last meeting, he even emphasised again, "We are very happy with your work, Cathy".

This approach is damaging and does not reflect the full context, including the positive delivery outcomes provided to the project team.

Cathy

From: Jonathan Navarrete <Jonathan.Navarrete@mcdgroup.com>
Sent: Tuesday, May 19, 2026 8:37 AM
To: Cathy Choi <Cathy.Choi@mcdgroup.com>
Subject: FW: Time keeping Close out

Cathy, James wants to meet again on this, can I please ask you to do a final wrap up on this, go through every single line of yours and add the drawing reference next to and send it back to me by end of tomorrow, I will review on Thursday and go through with him. I know you may have done this in another spreadsheet, can you please transfer and complete on this one and send back

Thanks

A	B	E	F	G	H	I
DATE	USER	TASK	HOURS	SHORT DESCRIPTION	DRAWING # REF.	
15/09/2025	Cathy Choi	Eng Service Request ESR002	9.00	modelling the bridge planks, added rebars,		
16/09/2025	Cathy Choi	Eng Service Request ESR002	7.17	Rebars updated, as V1 drafts did not clearly		
16/09/2025	Cathy Choi	Eng Service Request ESR002	1.75	Received feedback and confirmed the rebar arrangement. The slope on the slab cancled.		
17/09/2025	Cathy Choi	Eng Service Request ESR002	9.17	new markups, detailed staggered rebar and sizes.		
18/09/2025	Cathy Choi	Eng Service Request ESR002	9.00	Completed the latest markups, annotations, fonts, and format; sent back to the team.		
19/09/2025	Cathy Choi	Eng Service Request ESR002	8.67	A few new updates have confirmed the amount and spacing of the bars and updated after the quick		
22/09/2025	Cathy Choi	Eng Service Request ESR002	9.00	panel changed size& new rebar designed.		
23/09/2025	Cathy Choi	Eng Service Request ESR002	9.00	plate detailed started; PC2 panel drafting.		
24/09/2025	Cathy Choi	Eng Service Request ESR002	8.83	crossing section plate completing, rebar markup		
25/09/2025	Cathy Choi	Eng Service Request ESR002	9.08	The cross-section plate model design changed. PC		
26/09/2025	Cathy Choi	Digital Engineering Support / Mgmt	8.58	completing the final markups from Tim		
29/09/2025	Cathy Choi	Digital Engineering Support / Mgmt	9.00	rebars added at panel ends reduce straight bars		
30/09/2025	Cathy Choi	Digital Engineering Support / Mgmt	8.67	PC2 rises at the joint end and the plate's new		
01/10/2025	Cathy Choi	Digital Engineering Support / Mgmt	9.00	To avoid a clash between plate rods and bars, a dynamic plate test was created for different distances of rods and the starting point of rods to		
02/10/2025	Cathy Choi	Digital Engineering Support / Mgmt	9.67	updating sheets & modification		
03/10/2025	Cathy Choi	Digital Engineering Support / Mgmt	8.67	new markups completed.		

Kind regards,

Jonathan Navarrete

Digital Engineering Manager NZ&PI

McConnell Dowell

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From: Jonathan Navarrete
Sent: Tuesday, 19 May 2026 8:01 am
To: Cathy Choi <Cathy.Choi@mcdgroup.com>
Subject: RE: Time keeping Close out

Cathy, following up our conversation from yesterday, I want to put this as a record of been the **last informal warning** on this matter, and future events I will have not choice but escalate to HR, following recording the facts that got us to this point.

Here is the timeline of events:

- First Instance - 03 March 2026: Query from James, questioning the excessive among of hours recorded to what he though was a lot simpler.
    - We explained some of the reasons of this and I agreed to offer monthly records going forward as one of their issues was seen hours long time after works done.
    - We did agree to involve James on any request from Nafanua to ensure alignment and expectations before starting any new tasks.

- Second instance – 10 April 2026, after few months reports issues to James he realised a discrepancy in February, where an entire week of hours were missing at the time I did report out of Myhours systems
    - After investigating how this would occur, I find out that you completely missed to record an entire week of hours and added them at later stage, creating these big discrepancies.
    - We seat down again (20-04-26) and I expressed the importance of keeping myhours records correctly and requested them to be daily as minimum and with accurate descriptions; I showed you several samples of other team members keeping multiple records during the day, so were really no excuses to accomplish such request. You agreed and committed to keep this records going forward.

- Third instance - 14 May 2026: James reached out query on a specific tasks "*on 21/04 and 23/04 that took 8.5hrs and 7.5hrs*" where you reply was "*part of the 7.5 hours recorded on April 23rd was not accurate, as the whole team had issues with Autodesk for almost a week. My laptop worked properly after Stephens reset it on 23 Apr (from 1 pm to 2:30 pm). The actual time dedicated to the Nafaua request that day was roughly 2 hours*"

This series of incidents have damaged the trust of our project managers on our ability to keep good records of our activities, and I feel this is unfair for the rest of the team who have keep this tidy.

Also, to avoid any further issue, please **DO NOT undertake** any future tasks for this project. I will communicate this to James today.

Thanks and let me know if you wish to discuss any futher.

Kind regards,

Jonathan Navarrete

Digital Engineering Manager NZ&PI

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-----Original Appointment-----
From: Jonathan Navarrete
Sent: Monday, 18 May 2026 2:36 pm
To: Jonathan Navarrete; Cathy Choi
Subject: Time keeping Close out
When: Monday, 18 May 2026 3:00 pm-3:30 pm (UTC+12:00) Auckland, Wellington.
Where: NZ-AKL TheNoises

Cathy, can we jump 5 min on a quick catch up to close out this time keeping recurrent issue once for all?

Should be very quick